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License plate reader cameras help deputies find missing Liberty man with Alzheimer's

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Chloe Godding

A man with Alzheimer's disease who left home earlier this week is safe after an assist from law enforcement technology.

Video above: Heart of the Matter -- Privacy concerns raised about license plate readers

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On Wednesday night, a Liberty, Missouri, woman reported that her husband, who was elderly and prone to getting lost, had left home in a truck and had been gone for a couple of hours.

A Liberty Police Department officer entered the vehicle's license plate number into the Flock database to try to find him. Flock is a system of cameras that can read license plates to help law enforcement prevent crime, respond to public safety issues and locate offenders.

A Clay County Sheriff's Office deputy heard that one of the Flock cameras pinged the man's license plate about an hour and a half later. The deputy searched the area and found the truck on Highway 69 near Northeast 112th Street.

He pulled the man over and learned that the man did not know where he was or what day it was.

The deputy spoke with his wife before driving him home in his truck with a sergeant following them.

"A combination of technology and caring led to the man getting home safely," the sheriff's office said in a social media post.



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